

FIRE WATER TANK COMPLIANCE GUIDE

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Owner Reference Resource

Purpose

This resource is useful enough to help asset owners identify issues, keep useful records, and decide when to escalate – it is not a repair guide, design guide, or compliance certificate.

Plain-language owner guide for keeping fire water storage serviceable and inspection-ready.

Important Scope Note

This guide is general information only. It is not legal advice, design advice, certification, or a substitute for a formal fire protection inspection.

AS2304 and AS1851 requirements depend on the site, system design, authority requirements, tank type and maintenance history. Use this guide to understand what should be visible, recorded and escalated.

What This Guide Helps You Do

- Understand the owner-level intent of AS2304 and AS1851.
- Know what records should be kept.
- Identify common fire water tank issues.
- Decide when a formal inspection or condition review is needed.

What This Guide Does Not Cover

- Fire water tank sizing.
- Hydraulic calculations.
- Fire system design.
- Certification pathway advice.
- Clause-by-clause compliance interpretation.
- Repair or replacement specification.

AS2304 In Practice

AS2304 relates to fire water storage tanks. From an owner perspective, the practical question is:

Can the tank provide reliable fire water storage when it is needed?

That means the tank should be:

- Structurally serviceable.
- Accessible for inspection and maintenance.
- Free from obvious leaks or deterioration.
- Fitted with serviceable access, vents, overflows and pipe connections.
- Managed with records that show known defects were acted on.

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AS1851 In Practice

AS1851 relates to routine service of fire protection systems. From an owner perspective, the practical question is:

Can you demonstrate that the fire water storage asset is being inspected, maintained and followed up?

That means the owner should keep:

- Inspection records.
- Defect notes.
- Photos.
- Rectification records.
- Any specialist review reports.
- Evidence that repeat issues were escalated.

Owner Compliance Checklist

Area	Owner Check	Status	Notes
Water storage	No obvious sign of unexplained loss, leak or unavailable volume.	Pass / Watch / Escalate	
Tank shell	No severe corrosion, deformation, open joints or impact damage visible.	Pass / Watch / Escalate	
Roof and hatch	Secure, intact and serviceable.	Pass / Watch / Escalate	
Access	Safe access for inspection and maintenance.	Pass / Watch / Escalate	
Pipework	Visible fittings, flanges and penetrations free from active leaks.	Pass / Watch / Escalate	
Vents and overflow	Screens and overflow route appear clear and undamaged.	Pass / Watch / Escalate	
Base and foundation	No clear settlement, washout or support issue.	Pass / Watch / Escalate	
Records	Current inspection and maintenance records available.	Pass / Watch / Escalate	

Common Non-Compliances and Asset Risks

- Unsafe or incomplete access.
- Corrosion at penetrations, roof edges or base details.
- Leaks treated as minor housekeeping issues.
- Missing inspection records.
- Blocked or damaged vents.
- Poor visibility of tank condition due to overgrown access.
- Aged tanks kept in service without condition review.

What PC Tanks Reviews

When reviewing a fire water tank, PC Tanks typically considers:

- Tank shell condition.
- Roof, hatch and access condition.
- Pipe penetrations and fittings.
- Foundation and support.
- Visible coating or lining condition.
- Leak history.
- Maintenance records.
- Whether the asset condition matches its fire protection role.

This is an asset review, not just a visual check that water is present.

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Escalation Triggers

Arrange a site-specific review if:

- The tank has active or repeated leaks.
- Corrosion is spreading.
- Access is unsafe.
- Inspection records are missing or unclear.
- The tank has not been reviewed on a reasonable cycle.
- You are unsure whether deterioration affects fire water availability.

Do Not Rely On

- A visible water level as proof of compliance.
- Patch repairs without understanding the underlying defect.
- Old inspection records for a tank whose condition has changed.
- Informal assumptions about AS2304 or AS1851 obligations.

Next Step

If the tank is critical to fire protection, the condition *and* the records both need to stand up to review.

PC Tanks inspects fire water tanks against AS2304 and AS1851 owner expectations, identifies practical compliance and asset risks, and advises whether the next step is maintenance, refurbishment, replacement or further engineering review. We deliver findings the way an auditor or insurer wants to see them.

Book a fire water tank review – call 1300 029 804, email info@pcwater.com.au, or visit pcwater.com.au.